

PROJECT MANAGEMENT – SHORT & LONG ANSWERS (50 WORDS EACH)

1. Define a project.

A project is a temporary endeavor undertaken to create a unique product, service, or result. It has a defined start and end, specific objectives, limited resources, and requires coordinated efforts to achieve planned goals within given constraints.

2. List three key characteristics of a project.

The three key characteristics of a project are its temporary nature, a unique outcome or deliverable, and clearly defined objectives. Projects also involve limited resources and planned activities to achieve specific goals.

3. What is meant by progressive elaboration?

Progressive elaboration refers to the process of continuously improving and detailing a project plan as more information becomes available. Project scope and details are developed gradually throughout the project lifecycle.

4. What are the three primary constraints of a project?

The three primary constraints of a project are scope, time, and cost. These constraints are interconnected, and changes in one constraint directly impact the others and overall project quality.

5. Explain project scope.

Project scope defines all the work required to complete a project successfully. It outlines deliverables, tasks, boundaries, and objectives, ensuring clarity and preventing scope creep during execution.

6. Define project management.

Project management is the application of knowledge, skills, tools, and techniques to project activities to meet objectives while balancing scope, time, cost, quality, and stakeholder expectations.

7. Who are the key stakeholders in a project?

Key stakeholders include the project sponsor, project manager, team members, customers, clients, suppliers, and end users who influence or are affected by the project outcome.

8. What is the role of a project sponsor?

The project sponsor provides financial support, strategic direction, and authority. They approve major decisions, remove obstacles, and ensure alignment with organizational objectives.

9. Mention three project management knowledge areas.

Three project management knowledge areas are scope management, schedule management, and cost management, which help in planning, executing, and controlling project activities effectively.

10. What is risk management in project management?

Risk management involves identifying, analyzing, and responding to potential risks that may affect project objectives. It helps minimize negative impacts and improve project success.

11. Define project integration management.

Project integration management ensures that all project components are properly coordinated. It involves developing project charters, managing changes, and aligning processes across the project.

12. What is the purpose of a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)?

A Work Breakdown Structure divides the project into smaller, manageable components. It helps in planning, estimating costs, assigning responsibilities, and tracking progress efficiently.

13. Explain the use of Earned Value Management (EVM).

Earned Value Management is used to measure project performance by comparing planned work, completed work, and actual costs to evaluate schedule and cost efficiency.

14. Differentiate between project, program, and portfolio management.

Project management focuses on a single objective. Program management coordinates related projects, while portfolio management oversees all projects to align them with organizational strategy.

15. List two tools used for project scheduling.

Two commonly used project scheduling tools are Gantt charts and network diagrams. These tools help visualize timelines, task dependencies, and project progress.

16. What is Agile methodology?

Agile methodology is an iterative and flexible approach emphasizing customer collaboration, continuous feedback, and incremental delivery, allowing teams to adapt quickly to changes.

17. Define Scrum in Agile project management.

Scrum is an Agile framework that uses short, time-boxed iterations called sprints. It includes defined roles, events, and artifacts to deliver value incrementally.

18. What is a Kanban board?

A Kanban board is a visual workflow management tool that displays tasks in columns representing different stages, helping teams track progress and manage work efficiently.

19. Mention one advantage of Agile methodology.

One major advantage of Agile methodology is its flexibility, allowing teams to respond quickly to changing requirements and deliver value continuously.

20. Define the Waterfall model.

The Waterfall model is a traditional, linear project management approach where each phase is completed sequentially before moving to the next phase.

21. What are the main phases of the Waterfall methodology?

The main phases of Waterfall are requirement analysis, system design, development, testing, deployment, and maintenance, executed in a fixed sequence.

22. What are the advantages of Waterfall methodology?

Waterfall methodology offers clear structure, detailed documentation, and ease of management, making it suitable for projects with stable and well-defined requirements.

23. What is the role of a project manager?

A project manager plans, executes, monitors, and closes projects. They manage resources, risks, schedules, and stakeholder communication to achieve objectives.

24. What are the key skills required for a project manager?

Key skills include leadership, communication, time management, problem-solving, decision-making, and risk management for successful project execution.

25. Define stakeholder management in project management.

Stakeholder management involves identifying stakeholders, understanding their expectations, and managing their engagement to ensure project success.

26. What is the role of communication in project management?

Communication ensures effective information flow among stakeholders, improves coordination, reduces misunderstandings, and supports decision-making throughout the project lifecycle.

27. Explain the importance of leadership skills in project management.

Leadership skills help motivate teams, resolve conflicts, guide decisions, and ensure collaboration, contributing significantly to project success.

28. What is project procurement management?

Project procurement management involves acquiring goods and services from external vendors through planning, selection, contracting, and contract administration.

29. Define project cost management.

Project cost management includes estimating, budgeting, and controlling costs to ensure the project is completed within the approved budget.

30. What is project quality management?

Project quality management ensures that project deliverables meet required standards through quality planning, assurance, and control activities.

31. What is the significance of resource management in a project?

Resource management ensures optimal use of human, material, and financial resources, preventing shortages or over-allocation and improving efficiency.

32. Explain the concept of progressive elaboration.

Progressive elaboration means continuously refining project details as more information becomes available, allowing better planning and execution over time.

33. Mention one challenge faced in project management.

One common challenge in project management is scope creep, where uncontrolled changes increase work, cost, and time requirements.

34. How does Jira help in project management?

Jira helps manage projects by tracking tasks, issues, and progress. It supports Agile practices like sprint planning and backlog management.

35. List two key features of Jira.

Two key features of Jira are issue tracking and sprint management, which help teams plan, track, and deliver work efficiently.

36. What is project monitoring and control?

Project monitoring and control involve tracking performance, comparing actual progress with plans, and taking corrective actions when necessary.

37. Define ethical behaviour in project management.

Ethical behaviour in project management involves honesty, fairness, transparency, and responsibility in decision-making and professional conduct.

38. What is the significance of project documentation?

Project documentation provides reference, accountability, knowledge sharing, and clarity, helping ensure consistency and smooth project execution.

39. What are some common project management certifications?

Common certifications include PMP, CAPM, PRINCE2, Agile Certified Practitioner, and Scrum Master certifications.

40. How does project management software help in managing tasks?

Project management software helps organize, assign, track, and monitor tasks efficiently, improving collaboration, visibility, and productivity.

LONG ANSWER QUESTIONS

1. Explain the concept of a project and its key characteristics with examples.

A project is a temporary effort to create a unique product or service. It has defined objectives, limited duration, allocated resources, and specific deliverables. Example: developing a mobile application or constructing a building.

2. What is the Triple Constraint? Discuss its impact on project success.

The Triple Constraint includes scope, time, and cost. Balancing these constraints is crucial, as changes in one affect the others, influencing project quality and success.

3. Define project management and explain its importance in organizations.

Project management ensures effective planning, execution, and control of work. It helps organizations manage risks, optimize resources, and achieve strategic objectives efficiently.

4. Discuss the various project stakeholders and their roles in a project.

Project stakeholders include sponsors, managers, team members, customers, and suppliers. Their roles influence decision-making, execution, and project outcomes.

5. Explain the ten project management knowledge areas as per PMBOK.

PMBOK defines ten areas: integration, scope, schedule, cost, quality, resource, communication, risk, procurement, and stakeholder management for effective control.

6. Describe the various tools and techniques used in project management.

Common tools include Gantt charts, WBS, risk registers, network diagrams, and Earned Value Management to plan, track, and control projects.

7. Compare and contrast project, program, and portfolio management.

Project management handles a single goal, program management coordinates related projects, and portfolio management aligns projects with organizational strategy.

8. What is Agile methodology? Explain its principles and benefits.

Agile emphasizes flexibility, customer collaboration, iterative development, and continuous improvement, enabling faster delivery and adaptability to change.

9. Describe the Scrum framework and its key components.

Scrum is an Agile framework using sprints, defined roles, events, and artifacts to deliver incremental value efficiently.

10. Explain the differences between Agile and Waterfall methodologies.

Agile is iterative and flexible, while Waterfall is linear and sequential. Agile adapts to changes easily, whereas Waterfall requires fixed requirements.

11. What are the key phases of the Waterfall model? Discuss its advantages and disadvantages.

Waterfall phases include requirements, design, development, testing, deployment, and maintenance. It is structured but lacks flexibility for change.

12. Discuss the role of a project manager and the skills required.

A project manager plans, executes, and controls projects using leadership, communication, risk management, and problem-solving skills.

13. How does leadership influence project success? Provide examples.

Leadership motivates teams, resolves conflicts, and guides decisions. Effective leadership

improves collaboration and timely project completion.

14. Explain risk management in projects with suitable examples.

Risk management identifies and mitigates potential issues. For example, planning backup suppliers reduces delays caused by supply shortages.

15. Discuss the significance of communication in project management.

Effective communication ensures clarity, coordination, transparency, and alignment among stakeholders, reducing misunderstandings.

16. What is project quality management? How can it be implemented effectively?

Quality management ensures standards through planning, assurance, and control using reviews, audits, and testing.

17. Describe the use of Jira in project management and its key features.

Jira supports task tracking, sprint planning, issue management, and reporting, improving team collaboration and visibility.

18. Explain the ethical considerations in project management with examples.

Ethics involve honesty, transparency, and fairness, such as accurate reporting and responsible use of project resources.

19. What is project procurement management? Discuss its process and importance.

Procurement management involves planning, vendor selection, contracting, and managing purchases to ensure timely delivery of goods and services.

20. How has project management evolved historically?

Project management evolved from traditional methods to formal frameworks like PMBOK and Agile, supported by modern software tools.